Contextual Differentiation Design Canvas

InnoPlot Innovation Paradox Thinking Toolkit | v2.3

Think visually. Decide intuitively. Test systematically.

COMPLETED EXAMPLE

A3 LANDSCAPE | DESIGN & TEST

01 CONTEXT DEFINITION

Existing products: Market Pull

New market applications: balanced approach

Long-term technology: Capability Push

02 APPROACH PER CONTEXT

Existing: customer-led improvements

New markets: match capabilities to needs

Long-term: explore emerging technology

Share insights at portfolio reviews

03 KEY INITIATIVES

Define innovation tracks and criteria

Pilot distinct decision rules in two tracks

Schedule cross-context learning reviews

04 CAPABILITIES & RESOURCES

Product management and customer insight

R&D roadmaps and technology scouting

Portfolio leadership and knowledge sharing

05 EXPECTED VALUE

More relevant incremental innovation

Room for breakthrough exploration

Better allocation of innovation resources

06 RISKS & TRADE-OFFS

Risk: silo thinking between contexts

Mitigate: shared portfolio review

Risk: competition for specialist capacity

Mitigate: transparent resource decisions

07 KEY HYPOTHESIS & FIRST EXPERIMENT

BELIEF: Different contexts need different balances of Capability Push and Market Pull.

TEST: Pilot two innovation initiatives.

EVIDENCE: Decision quality and speed.

08 NEXT STEPS & LEARNING REVIEW

OWNER: Portfolio manager + R&D lead

REVIEW: After two portfolio cycles

DECIDE: Retain, refine or revise contexts